
EDUCATION

Tennessee Technological University (August 2024 - May 2028)

- Bachelor's of Computer Science
- Concentration in Cybersecurity

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Security Research Intern | Cisco | Knoxville, TN (May 2025 - Present)

- Reviewed vulnerability fixes to evaluate if patches against critical command injection, cross-site scripting, and privilege escalation vulnerabilities, were sufficient for remediation.
- Scanned software bundles with tools such as Trufflehog, GitGuardian, and Gitleaks to look for credential leaks.

Information Technology | Putnam County Technology Department | Cookeville, TN (July 2022)

- Answered technical calls and took on a troubleshooting mindset to debug end-user problems.
- Analyzed security logs and examined quarantined emails flagged for phishing attacks and malware in Outlook.

Penetration Tester | ZOE International (August 2025 - January 2026)

- Conducted assessments against multiple web services with scope pro-bono
- Utilized Burp Suite, gobuster, and other industry standard tools to probe end services.
- Delivered a report with a document of findings and explanations for remediating vulnerabilities.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA **Security+** - January 2026

- Credential ID: 9bc61bb7a2454090892154a86b52d2f3

Offsec Certified Professional+ - December 2025

- Credentials Link: <https://credentials.offsec.com/4c432538-877f-41ec-8032-66e6aa15100d#acc.35VLZdeF>

Certified Red Team Operator - January 2025

- Obtained and practiced Active Directory exploitation and Defender Evasion with Cobalt Strike.
- Practiced exploitation of **Resourced-Based Constrained Delegation**, **Trust abuse**, and **vulnerable certificate templates**

GIAC Foundational Cybersecurity Technologies - May 2024

- Credential Link: <https://www.credly.com/badges/9ce7e5ff-4baf-4bca-b9a2-b5aadf894404>

CompTIA IT Fundamentals+ - May 2022

COMPETITIONS

Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition - Co-Lead (January - April 2025, 2026)

- Placed **1st** at regionals round and **7th** as a national finalist
- Defended a compromised network of **40+** Linux / Windows Machines from an Active Red Team while maintaining critical services, reporting incidents, and keeping management well informed.
- Developed automation tooling in **Golang** and **PowerShell** to deploy scripts across Windows and Linux machines.
- Participated in weekly meetings with team members to advance my knowledge of system administration, networking, network security, cyber defense, incident response, and formal report writing.

Department of Energy CyberForce Competition (August 2025 - November 2026)

- Placed **3rd nationally** out of 96 teams in an 8 hour Defensive and Capture the Flag Challenge.
- Prepared and presented a **5 minute** security briefing video to the C-Suite members of the company.
- Worked within a team to defend a network of Windows and Linux Virtual Machines simulating an oil rig, placing **1st** in defense and service uptime.
- Solved over **80%** of Anomalies (CTF challenges) relating to malware analysis, forensics, energy, log analysis, cryptography, and stenography.

Penetration Tester - Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition (August 2024 - January 2025, 2026)

- Placed **1st** in the central region and **4th** as a national finalist.
- Successfully compromised multiple machines in the target environment, combining exploits and abusing misconfiguration.
- Professionally corresponded with simulated client, maintaining provided rules of engagement and scope.
- Wrote 65-page report including findings, suggestions for client, timeline, and documented vulnerabilities.

National Cyber League Competition - Team Member (January 2023 - Current)

- Placed **2nd** in team game.
- Solved challenges relating to Forensics, Cryptography, Password Cracking, Network Traffic Analysis.
- Used tools such as Autopsy, FTK Imager, Cyberchef, Dcode.fr, OpenSSL, Hashcat, Wireshark, Nmap, etc.

eCitadel (April 2025 - May 2025)

- Placed 6th nationally out of 176 teams in an 8 hour defensive/forensic analysis competition.
- Defended 4 machines from an automated red team, maintaining 99.99% critical service uptime.

SKILLS

- Soft Skills: Written Communication, Problem Solving, Time Management, Teamwork, Critical Thinking
- Offensive Cyber Tools: Cobalt Strike, impacket, Rubeus, Burp Suite, NetExec, Mimikatz, gobuster
- Defensive Cyber Tools: Wireshark, Coordinate, iptables, Pfsense, SysInternals
- Virtualization and Cloud: VMware ESXI, Proxmox, Google Cloud Platform, Amazon Web Services
- Automation: SaltStack, Ansible, Coordinate
- Frameworks & Methodologies: PTES, MITRE ATT&CK, OWASP

ON-CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT

CyberEagles Competition Club Lead | Tennessee Tech (September 2024 - Present)

- Co-Founded and currently leading a collegiate cybersecurity competition club focused on advanced offensive and defensive topics, including Active Directory exploitation, web application testing, incident response, and network defense.
- Design and run hands-on practice labs and internal scrimmages that mirror national competitions for student preparation.
- Mentored and led fellow students to achieve multiple national-level podium finishes and first-ever placements in Tennessee Tech history.

CyberEagles Engineering Joint Council Member | Tennessee Tech (March 2026 - Present)

- Informed other clubs and faculty of the council about the aspiration of CyberEagles.
- Continued collaboration with other clubs to further the education and socialization of students.
- Advocated for increased funding of weekly club meetings.

Tennessee Tech Cyber Interest Groups Mentor (January 2025 - Present)

- Plan weekly topics and presentation; design and maintain lab infrastructure simulating offensive and defensive environments.
- Lead small teams to develop content and deliver member-facing presentations.
- Coach members through hands-on labs; provide guidance on tooling, workflows, and environment usage.

PROJECTS

Home Lab

- Proxmox server to host Cyber Eagles Competition Club's Cyber Range.
- Deployed defensive/offensive environments to learn technical skills and and conduct cyber security research.
- Wrote custom scripts to automate infrastructure deployment with SaltStack and Terraform.
- Utilized open-source firewall solutions like openwrt and pfsense to partition networking, monitor network traffic, and allow tailscale access into projects.

Coordinate

- Custom Golang application built for Linux administration by utilizing SSH connections.
- Support for command execution, script exection, file transfer, key authentication, password changes and sudo escalation.
- <https://github.com/Foister150/coordinate-foister>